roads, irrigation schemes, houses, the spread of sanitation and medical facilities, of industry, electricity, social and cultural services, education, and the provision of the scores of necessary articles that the people lack. All our millions can work hard for the next fifty years without exhausting the present possibilities. But that can only be done if the urge is social improvement and not the profit motive, and if the community organises it for the general good. The Russian Soviet Union, whatever other shortcomings it may possess, has no unemployed. Our people are idle not for lack of work, but because no facilities for work and cultural improvement are provided for them. The abolition of child labour, the provision of compulsory education up to a reasonable age, would take boys and girls off from the ranks of labour or the unemployed, and relieve the labour market of the weight of tens of millions of prospective workers.

Gandhiji has tried, with some success, to improve the *charkha* and the *takli* and increase their productive capacities. That is an attempt to improve the tool and the machine, and if the improvement continues (it is quite conceivable to have cottage industries worked by electricity), the profit motive will again step in and produce what is called over-production and unemployment. Village industries without being tacked on to some modern industrial technique can never provide even the essential material and cultural goods that we need to-day. And they cannot compete with the machine. Is it desirable or possible for us to stop the functioning of big-scale machinery in our country? Gandhiji has said repeatedly that he is not against machinery as such; he seems to think that it is out of place in India to-day. But can we wind up the basic industries, such as iron and steel, or even the lighter ones that already exist?

It is obvious that we cannot do so. If we have railways, bridges, transport facilities, etc., we must either produce them ourselves or depend on others. If we want to have the means of defence we must not only have the basic industries but a highly developed industrial system. No country to-day is really independent or capable of resisting aggression unless it is industrially developed. One basic industry demands another for its support and as a complement to it, and finally we have the machine-building industry itself. With all these basic industries functioning it is inevitable that the lighter industries should spread. There is no stopping this process, for not only is our material and cultural progress bound up with it, but also our